

Quiet moves can make forcing threats

Thinking And Training

THE IDEA

A quiet move is neither a check nor a capture, yet it can decide a tactical position by threatening mate, restricting escape squares, or improving coordination. Find it by identifying what your forcing lines are missing.

WORKED EXAMPLE

Your queen is near the king but every check lets the king escape. A quiet bishop move may cover the escape square and threaten an unavoidable mate. The move only works if it gives the opponent no stronger counterplay.

TRY IT BEFORE READING ON

How can failed checking lines help you find a quiet move?

ANSWER AND REASONING

Identify the defender's recurring escape or defensive resource. Look for a move that removes that resource while maintaining your threats. Then test all forcing replies.

TAKE THIS INTO YOUR NEXT GAME

Use failed checks to diagnose the missing support.